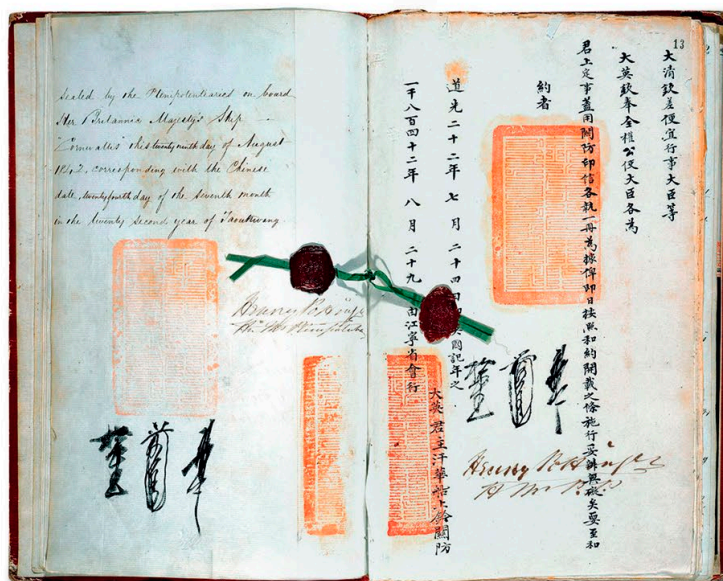


1842

TREATY OF NANJING

The First Opium War ended in defeat for China in 1842. Under the punitive terms of the Treaty of Nanjing – the first of several “unequal treaties” – China was forced to open more ports to British trade, pay 21 million silver dollars compensation, and cede the island of Hong Kong to the British. The British-controlled territory later expanded to include part of the Kowloon Peninsula.

▷ Treaty of Nanjing, August 1842



1840

1841 War erupts between Siam and Vietnam in Cambodia when Vietnam absorbs Cambodia and demotes the Khmer rulers

1845-52 The Great Famine in Ireland claims the lives of one million as potato blight devastates crops and the British government exacerbates the crisis

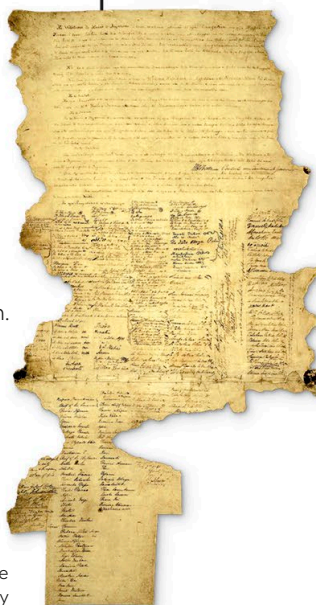
1844 Samuel Morse sends the world's first telegraph message, from Washington, D.C. to Baltimore, Maryland

1840

TREATY OF WAITANGI

New Zealand's founding document, The Treaty of Waitangi, was an agreement between the British Crown and 540 Maori *rangatira* (chiefs) in which control over New Zealand was ceded to Britain. The New Zealand Wars broke out when the colonial government took increasing control over Maori affairs in 1845. They lasted until 1872.

▷ Waitangi Sheet, one of nine copies of the Treaty



1848

A YEAR OF REVOLUTIONS

A wave of revolutions spread through Europe affecting France, Italy, Hungary, Austria, and Prussia, among others. Driven by multiple factors, including nationalism and demands for the removal of old monarchical structures, the revolutions largely ended in repression but did bring about the abolition of serfdom in Austria and Hungary, the end of absolute monarchy in Denmark, and the establishment of the Second Republic in France.

